

Question 15 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse the relationship among HRD philosophy, HRD climate, and organisational performance.

Answer

Philosophy, climate and performance form a causal chain. Philosophy shapes practices; practices shape climate; climate shapes behaviour and thus performance.

- 1. HRD philosophy:** Belief that people have potential, deserve development, and that development is a managerial duty—not a cost to minimise.
- 2. Philosophy drives mechanisms:** If philosophy is genuine, appraisal is developmental, training is need-based, and bosses counsel rather than only control.
- 3. Mechanisms create climate:** Consistent practices produce perceptions of openness, trust and support (HRD climate).
- 4. Climate shapes behaviour:** Employees take initiative, learn, collaborate and persist when climate is supportive.
- 5. Behaviour produces performance:** Quality, productivity, innovation and customer service improve.
- 6. Reverse effect:** High performance can reinforce philosophy ('investment in people pays'). Poor results with no reflection may wrongly kill HRD budgets.
- 7. Inconsistency problem:** Stated philosophy without matching climate (e.g., slogans vs punitive bosses) creates cynicism and hurts performance.
- 8. Strategic implication:** Sustainable performance requires all three: believed philosophy, felt climate, and results—not isolated training events.

Conclusion. Hence organisational performance is strongest when a true HRD philosophy is lived as climate, not merely written in HR manuals.